Larkspur Freight Employee Handbook 2025

1. On-Call Compensation: Expectations and Responsibilities

Employees on-call must:
• Respond to all alerts from the OpsAlert system within 15 minutes.
• Be reachable by phone and Slack (LarkspurOps channel) at all times during the shift.
• Log all incidents and actions in the IncidentTracker portal within 2 hours of resolution.
• Coordinate with external vendors (e.g., CargoSync, FleetPulse) as needed.
Failure to meet these expectations may result in forfeiture of on-call pay for the affected shift, subject to review by the Operations Manager (currently: Priya Desai, Savannah office).

2. Remote Work Stipend: Ineligible Expenses

• Rent or mortgage payments
• Furniture not related to work (e.g., couches, beds)
• Personal electronics (TVs, gaming consoles)
• Food and beverage
• Childcare or pet care
Any expenses not listed as eligible must be pre-approved by the HR Business Partner (currently: Daniel Rios). Submitting ineligible expenses may result in stipend suspension for up to 2 months.

3. Data Retention: Deletion Schedules and Automation

Data deletion is scheduled monthly on the 15th using the DataSweep Pro tool (vendor: ByteHarbor Solutions). Automated scripts flag eligible records for deletion, and a manual review is conducted by the Data Compliance Officer (currently: Marcus Lin). Exceptions require written approval from the department head. Physical records are shredded quarterly by SecureShred Inc. (invoice avg: $1,200/quarter).

4. Special Categories and Exceptions

• Fuel purchases from approved vendors (e.g., PetroMax) are exempt from competitive bid requirements but must be reconciled monthly.
• Software subscriptions (e.g., FleetOps Tracker) over $3,000/year require IT and Finance joint approval.
• Any purchase over $50,000 requires Board notification at least 10 days prior to commitment.
• Sole-source justifications must be documented and signed by the requesting manager and Procurement Lead.

5. Corporate Card Usage: Transaction Limits and Controls

Each card has a default single-transaction limit of $1,500. Transactions above this amount require pre-approval from the Finance Manager (currently Priya Desai). Monthly spend is capped at $5,000 unless otherwise authorized. Cards are monitored via the SpendGuard tool, which flags:
• Transactions over $1,000
• Multiple transactions at the same vendor in 24 hours
• Weekend spending over $500

Cardholders receive automated alerts for flagged activity. Persistent overages may result in card revocation.

6. Paid Time Off (PTO): Tracking and Reporting

PTO balances are updated in real time in the WorkNest HR portal. Employees can view their current balance, accrual rate, and pending requests at any time. HR will send quarterly PTO balance summaries via email. Discrepancies should be reported to hr@larkspurfreight.com within 30 days. Supervisors are responsible for monitoring team PTO usage to ensure adequate coverage.

7. Travel & Expenses: Exceptions and Special Cases

Requests for exceptions (e.g., higher hotel rates during conferences, additional baggage fees) must be submitted in writing to the Finance Manager before travel. Emergency expenses (e.g., medical, weather-related delays) will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis. Tacoma office employees may claim up to $25/day for winter gear rental (November–March) with supervisor approval. All exceptions must be documented in the expense report.

8. Driver Safety Manual: Vehicle Inspection Protocols

Drivers are required to complete a pre-trip inspection checklist before each shift using the FleetCheck app (vendor: RoadLogic). The checklist includes brakes, lights, tires, and emergency equipment. Dallas drivers must submit digital inspection logs by 7:00 AM daily. Any critical defect (e.g., brake failure, tire tread < 2/32") must be reported immediately to Fleet Maintenance (contact: Jorge Salinas). Non-critical issues must be logged within 12 hours.

9. Paid Time Off (PTO): PTO Accrual Rates

PTO accrues on a bi-weekly basis and is reflected in the WorkNest HR portal. Accrual rates by office:
• Dallas HQ: 15 days/year (0.577 days per pay period)
• Seattle: 18 days/year (0.692 days per pay period)
• Atlanta: 12 days/year (0.462 days per pay period)
Employees with 5+ years of service receive an additional 3 days/year. Accrual is capped at 1.5x the annual rate (e.g., Dallas max: 22.5 days).

10. Paid Time Off (PTO): PTO Carryover and Forfeiture

Unused PTO may be carried over into the next calendar year, subject to office-specific limits:
• Dallas HQ: Up to 7 days
• Seattle: Up to 10 days
• Atlanta: Up to 5 days
Any PTO above these limits as of January 31st will be forfeited. No cash payout for unused PTO except upon separation, per Section 7.

11. Relocation Assistance: Non-Covered Expenses

The following items are not reimbursable under this policy:
• Meals during travel
• Pet relocation fees

• Vehicle shipping (except for company-leased vehicles)
• Home purchase closing costs
• Furniture purchases
• Cleaning services
Employees are encouraged to review the full list of exclusions on the HR SharePoint (folder: hr/relocation). Exceptions may be considered on a case-by-case basis with written approval from the HR Director.

12. Relocation Assistance: Covered Expenses

The following expenses are covered under the relocation policy, up to a maximum of $10,000 per move:
• Transportation of household goods (via SwiftHaul or BlueBox Movers)
• Temporary housing for up to 30 days (booked through StayBridge Corporate)
• One-way airfare for employee and immediate family (economy class)
• Lease termination fees up to $1,200
• Storage costs for up to 30 days
• Mileage reimbursement at $0.58/mile for personal vehicle moves
Receipts must be submitted within 30 days of incurring the expense. Any costs exceeding the cap are the employee’s responsibility.

13. Incident Response Plan: Recovery and Restoration

Systems may only be restored after written approval from the IT Security Team Lead. DataGuard backups must be used to restore any lost or corrupted data. For Dallas Terminal, restoration must be completed within 36 hours of containment. All restored systems must pass a vulnerability scan (using Nessus Pro) before being returned to production. Affected users are notified via email and required to reset passwords. Any financial losses over $2,000 USD must be reported to the CFO (James O’Malley) within 24 hours of discovery.

14. Warehouse Safety Procedures: Emergency Procedures

In case of fire, chemical spill, or medical emergency, activate the nearest alarm (located every 40 meters). Evacuation maps are posted at all exits. Assembly point for the North Office is Lot C; for the South Office, use the loading dock area. Emergency drills are held every 90 days (next scheduled: 2024-07-15). All staff must:
• Follow instructions from the Emergency Response Team (ERT)
• Do not re-enter the building until cleared by the ERT Lead (currently: Marcus O’Neill)
• Report missing persons to the ERT within 5 minutes of assembly
Failure to participate in drills results in a written warning.

15. Relocation Assistance: Office-Specific Provisions

Dallas Office: Employees are eligible for an additional $500 stipend for utility setup costs. Seattle Office: Temporary housing may be extended to 30 days due to local housing market constraints, subject to approval by the Seattle Office Manager. Atlanta Office: Lease termination fees are reimbursed up to $1,500. All offices: Spousal job search assistance is available through CareerConnect Partners upon request.